

FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Pandemic & disease outbreak

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QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Check current local health guidance for the specific disease. Reduce exposure, stay home when sick when feasible and seek care for severe symptoms. Recommended tests, vaccines, masks and isolation steps depend on the pathogen and your health risks.

Do now.

**Find current guidance**

01

Use the local health department and CDC disease-specific updates.

**Reduce transmission**

02

Improve cleaner indoor air and use recommended precautions for the way the disease spreads.

**Plan care**

03

Ask your clinician about risk, treatment access and continuity of essential medicines.

**Know urgent signs**

04

Seek emergency help for severe breathing difficulty, new confusion or other life-threatening symptoms.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Create a workable sick-person area, improve ventilation where safe and separate shared food, washing and care tasks. Keep medicines and a written symptom record. Obtain disease-specific guidance when possible; do not use unproven treatments or copy isolation rules from another outbreak.

Watch for.

Do not transfer isolation durations or treatment advice from one disease to another.

People & practical needs.

Make the care plan workable with the people, room and supplies you have. Separate clean and dirty tasks, check high-risk household members and preserve access to essential medicines. Keep a written record of symptoms and exposure rather than relying on memory. For this situation, brief every person on the first action: find current guidance. Agree who will manage children, pets or mobility needs while that action happens. Do not transfer isolation durations or treatment advice from one disease to another.

Keep essentials within reach.

For pandemic & disease outbreak, prioritize only items needed for the first action and the fallback: Create a workable sick-person area, improve ventilation where safe and separate shared food, washing and care tasks. Keep medicines and a written symptom record. Obtain disease-specific guidance when possible; do not use unproven treatments or copy isolation rules from another outbreak. Keep the relevant checklist and contact information within reach. Equipment retrieval must not delay the protective step.

Next decisions.

Arrange sick-leave, caregiver and household supply plans. Verify information before sharing it.

First decision: Find current guidance

Use the local health department and CDC disease-specific updates. Decide which person can carry this out immediately and what would prevent it in your current location. Do not delay the protective step to complete a household worksheet.

When the original plan fails

Create a workable sick-person area, improve ventilation where safe and separate shared food, washing and care tasks. Keep medicines and a written symptom record. Obtain disease-specific guidance when possible; do not use unproven treatments or copy isolation rules from another outbreak. Reassess the next available location or resource using the warning signs in this guide; do not assume a promised service is operating.

Before changing location

Do not transfer isolation durations or treatment advice from one disease to another. Check the actual route and the needs of the person who will have the most difficulty moving. A destination is not confirmed until access and conditions have been checked.

Questions in the field.

What matters before collecting supplies?

Check current local health guidance for the specific disease. Reduce exposure, stay home when sick when feasible and seek care for severe symptoms. Recommended tests, vaccines, masks and isolation steps depend on the pathogen and your health risks. Collect items only if doing so does not delay this action.

What should another household member do?

Use a second person to handle communication or dependents while the first carries out the immediate action. For pandemic & disease outbreak, keep the specific hazard in view: Do not transfer isolation durations or treatment advice from one disease to another.

What should be written down?

Record when the situation changed, what action was taken and what remains uncertain. For this situation, start with: Know urgent signs. Seek emergency help for severe breathing difficulty, new confusion or other life-threatening symptoms. Keep personal notes private; they are not submitted to Osprey Zero.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

Pandemic & disease outbreak · official guidance

<https://www.cdc.gov/respiratory-viruses/prevention/index.html>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/pandemic/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.